

5,000 years ago, nearly two-thirds of the wilderness has gone. Cities have replaced trees, water and air have become polluted, and some animals have been hunted so much that very few are left. Many species have disappeared completely along with the wilderness, and others have been left threatened with extinction. This book tells the story of some of them—but also explains what is being done around the world to help. Today, more people than ever are concerned about the future of planet Earth and its extraordinary variety of animals. These animals are what make our world such an amazing place—we must look after them.

Derek Harvey

Endangered animals

Where you see the panel below, it means the animals plotted on the maps are assessed by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN, see p.20) as being near threatened, vulnerable, endangered, or critically endangered. If there is no panel, or a species isn't listed, that means the animal is of least concern (not currently at risk) or has not been assessed by the IUCN.

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Lion

⚠️ IUCN status: vulnerable

📈 Population estimate: 20,000–32,000

Status
The IUCN category shows how endangered the animal is thought to be.

Population trend
An arrow indicates whether the number of animals is rising, falling, or stable.

Population number
The number given is a rough estimate. For some species, the number of animals remaining is not known.

